

rather than loading it to memory. This helps it to open very large files with ease. One major feature of EmEditor is that it auto-detects if the CSV file has an uneven number of columns, and it tries to fix it at the same time. Its large file controller helps it to read large files at once.

Key features

- Easily handles files up to 248 GB.
- It can split large files and can also combine files into one.
- Syntax highlighting and regular expressions are some of its main coding features.
- Customisable interface and quick launch makes the user experience better.
- Various free plugins make this tool more productive.
- Powerful and scriptable macros.
- The word count plug-in allows you to count specific terms or characters.
- Split window (up to four panes).
- Has the auto-save and auto-indent features.
- Support for external tools includes launching external programs via keyboard shortcuts or toolbar buttons.

Disadvantages

- Some of its features are available only on the pro edition, which is not free.

LogExpert

This is a Windows tail program, which serves as a GUI replacement for the UNIX tail command. It is very good at reading large files, and is free for commercial as well as non-commercial use.

Key features

- It has a plugin API for log file data sources.
- It supports the tail program and Unicode.
- Multiple plugin support is available from third party.
- MDI-interface with tabs.
- It has a search function including regular expressions.
- We can bookmark the search result and can add comments to bookmarks.
- Any change in the log file automatically gets updated in the same log file that is being used by the LogExpert too.
- It has a very flexible filter view.
- We can highlight lines with search criteria.
- *Columnizer* is its key feature, which helps it to split log file lines into several multiple columns for some well-defined log file formats.

Other alternatives to consider

- **Atom:** This is a freeware open source solution that

supports C++, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.

- **Visual Studio Code:** This is another free text editor created by Microsoft under the MIT licence.
- **GNU Emacs:** This is a very popular text editor derivative of the Emacs family, created by Richard Stallman for the GNU projects.

Tips to handle large files

- Do not close large files immediately after viewing them. You will be dealing with a lot of information and you wouldn't want to close a file only to realise that you need it open again. And besides, large files take time to open but, after that, it's all fine.
- It is good to have complete documentation of all the findings of large log files, as we may forget these later when we need to use them and end up wasting time in reopening the same large file.
- It is a good practice to keep your RAM as free as possible as most text editors load the files into the RAM to read them.
- More than a text editor, it's a RAM issue. If you want to edit a 5GB file and you do not have enough free RAM, then you will have to close any other open application to handle the opening of the large file, carefully.
- Instead of using a text editor tool, you may go ahead with the good old Grep command, or you could use the split function to split the large file into multiple files of smaller sizes, which are easy to handle.
- You can use `cmd` to open large files in Windows. First, open `cmd` with *Start>Run*. Navigate to your file location and then type the following command:

type <filename.extension> | more

Now the `cmd` window will show you a screen with the contents of the file. This happens quickly for large files also, without any time lag. You can copy the details from there as well. 

References

- [1] <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/>
- [2] <https://www.petri.com/>
- [3] <http://www.technoreply.com/>

By: Aakash Beniwal

The author works with Infosys Limited, Pune, as a testing engineer and has an experience of 2.5 years in that domain. He can be reached at aakashnavodaya@gmail.com.